

ShopSphere Operations

Enterprise Customer Support Knowledge Base (Vol 2)

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Last Updated: October 2023

KB-006: Payment Failure Troubleshooting

Document Owner: Financial Operations & Payments | **Applicability:** Tier 1 & Tier 2 Support Agents |
Related Systems: Payment Gateway API, Order Management System (OMS)

1. Overview and Scope

This document outlines the standard operating procedures for handling customer inquiries related to failed transactions during the checkout process. Payment failures can result from a variety of issues, including insufficient funds, bank declines, 3D Secure authentication timeouts, or internal fraud prevention triggers. Customer Service Representatives (CSRs) must carefully diagnose the root cause using the Payment Gateway API logs before advising the customer.

2. Failed Transaction Handling and Diagnosis

When a customer reports a failed transaction, the CSR must first locate the checkout attempt in the OMS. The system will display an overarching status of "Payment Failed," but the CSR must click into the "Gateway Response" tab to identify the specific error code.

- **Code 2001 (Insufficient Funds):** The customer's card does not have enough available credit or balance. Advise the customer to use an alternative payment method.
- **Code 2005 (Issuer Decline):** The customer's bank has blocked the transaction. The CSR must instruct the customer to complete standard bank verification by calling the number on the back of their card to authorize ShopSphere as a trusted merchant.

- **Code 2010 (3D Secure Failure):** The customer failed the OTP or biometric prompt. Provide guidance on ensuring strong network connectivity and disabling pop-up blockers, then ask them to retry.

3. Handling "Shadow Charges" and Bank Holds

A frequent point of friction occurs when a transaction fails in the ShopSphere OMS, but the customer's bank statement shows a pending charge. This is known as a "shadow charge" or authorization hold. CSRs must assure the customer that ShopSphere has not captured these funds.

Customer Communication Protocol: *"I understand you see a charge on your account. Because the transaction did not complete on our end, this is only a temporary bank authorization hold. ShopSphere has automatically sent a void request to your bank."*

4. Refund Reversal Timelines for Failed Authorizations

While ShopSphere instantly voids failed authorizations, the timeframe for the funds to reappear in the customer's available balance is strictly controlled by their financial institution. Standard refund reversal timelines dictate that shadow charges will clear within 3 to 5 business days for domestic credit cards, and up to 10 business days for debit cards or international payment methods. CSRs cannot expedite this process. If a customer demands a formal void receipt, Tier 2 Support can generate an Acquirer Reference Number (ARN) memo after 72 hours.

5. Escalation to Security

If a payment failure is accompanied by Gateway Code 3001 (High Risk Block), the transaction has intersected with the Fraud Detection and Security Review Workflow (KB-010). Do not instruct the customer to blindly retry the payment, as this will trigger an automated account lock. Instead, escalate the ticket to the Risk & Safety team for manual review.

KB-007: Order Cancellation Policy

Document Owner: Customer Success Operations | **Applicability:** All Support Staff | **Related Systems:** OMS, Warehouse Management System (WMS)

1. Policy Overview

The Order Cancellation Policy defines the strict eligibility rules, timeframes, and system workflows for halting an order before it leaves a ShopSphere fulfillment center. Because ShopSphere utilizes highly automated, rapid-dispatch warehouses, the window for a customer-initiated cancellation is incredibly brief. This document outlines how CSRs must manage these requests to prevent unintended shipments and subsequent return-processing overhead.

2. Cancellation Eligibility Rules and Timeframes

Customers can cancel standard orders directly via the self-service portal within 30 minutes of order placement, provided the OMS status remains in "Processing." ShopSphere Premium members have an extended cancellation window of 60 minutes.

Once the OMS status updates to "Sent to Warehouse" or "Picking," self-service cancellation is disabled. At this stage, CSRs can attempt a "Best Effort Intercept" by pinging the WMS. If the WMS responds with "Locked for Shipping," the cancellation must be denied. The CSR must then pivot to standard customer communication protocols, advising the buyer to utilize the Standard Return Policy once the item arrives.

3. Partial Cancellations and Bundle Adjustments

If a customer wishes to cancel only one item from a multi-item order, the CSR must evaluate the promotional eligibility. If the item being cancelled is part of a "Buy One, Get One" (BOGO) or bundle discount, the OMS will automatically recalculate the price of the remaining items. The CSR must clearly explain to the customer that their expected refund will be reduced to account for the forfeiture of the bundle discount. Custom-made or personalized items are strictly excluded from all cancellation workflows once 12 hours have passed since order placement.

4. Financial Processing and Refund Reversal Timelines

When an order is successfully cancelled prior to shipment, the financial workflow depends on whether the original charge was captured or merely authorized.

- **Authorized Only (Cancelled within 2 hours):** The payment authorization is voided. The customer will not see a refund; rather, the pending charge will simply drop off their statement within 3 to 5 business days (refer to Refund Reversal Timelines in KB-006).
- **Captured Funds:** If the funds were already settled, the OMS triggers an automated refund via the Payment Gateway API. Captured refunds typically reflect in the customer's account within 5 to 7 business days.

5. Intersecting Scenarios: EMI and Fraud

If an order placed using EMI or installment options (KB-009) is cancelled, the principal amount is refunded to the bank, but the bank's processing fees may be non-refundable. Furthermore, if an order cancellation was not initiated by the customer but rather triggered automatically by the system, the CSR must check the Fraud Engine logs. Orders cancelled due to suspected unauthorized access require the customer to complete the Account Recovery and Verification Process (KB-008) before they can place a new order.

KB-008: Account Recovery and Verification Process

Document Owner: Risk & Trust / Identity Verification | **Applicability:** Tier 2 Support, Trust & Safety |
Related Systems: CRM Secure Upload Portal, Identity Access Management (IAM)

1. Introduction

The Account Recovery and Verification Process is a highly sensitive workflow designed to restore access to legitimate account holders who have lost their credentials, failed Two-Factor Authentication (2FA), or had their accounts proactively locked due to suspicious activity. Due to the high risk of social engineering and account takeover (ATO) attacks, CSRs must rigidly adhere to these verification protocols without exception.

2. Triggers for Account Locking Procedures

ShopSphere's automated security systems will proactively lock an account under several conditions:

- Five consecutive failed password attempts.
- Three consecutive failed 2FA token entries.
- An explicit instruction from the Fraud Detection and Security Review Workflow (KB-010) due to severe billing/shipping mismatches or velocity anomalies.
- A customer explicitly calling to report their account has been compromised.

When an account is locked, the IAM system suspends all pending orders and revokes all active session tokens.

3. Verification Documents and Requirements

To initiate account recovery, the customer must prove their identity. Tier 1 agents cannot process identity documents; they must generate a secure upload link via the CRM and escalate the ticket to Tier 2. Customers are required to submit two forms of verification documents:

1. **Primary Identification:** A valid, unexpired, government-issued photo ID (e.g., Driver's License, Passport, or State ID). The name must exactly match the profile name on the ShopSphere account.
2. **Secondary Verification:** A recent utility bill or bank statement (dated within the last 60 days) displaying the customer's name and the primary billing address saved on their ShopSphere profile.

Exception Handling: If the customer has recently moved and cannot provide matching secondary verification, they must provide the last four digits of the primary credit card on file and the exact date and amount of their most recent successful purchase.

4. Review Workflow and SLAs

Once the verification documents are uploaded to the secure portal, the Trust & Safety team has a Service Level Agreement (SLA) of 48 business hours to complete the manual review. Agents must utilize optical character recognition (OCR) tools to detect forged or digitally manipulated documents. If the documents pass inspection, the agent will trigger a password reset link to the original email on file and lift the account lock.

5. Customer Communication Protocols

Communication during the account recovery process must be handled delicately but firmly. Agents must state clearly: *"For your security and the protection of your financial data, ShopSphere requires identity verification before restoring access. We cannot bypass this protocol under any circumstances."* Do not disclose the specific security triggers that led to the account locking procedures, as this provides bad actors with information on how to circumvent our security logic in the future.

KB-009: EMI and Installment Payment Support

Document Owner: Financial Partnerships | **Applicability:** Billing Support Agents | **Related Systems:** OMS, Banking Partner API

1. Scope and Eligibility

ShopSphere partners with multiple financial institutions to offer Equated Monthly Installment (EMI) plans, allowing customers to finance high-ticket purchases. This document provides guidance on supporting EMI inquiries, understanding conversion workflows, and managing cancellations. EMI options are restricted to carts with a minimum subtotal of \$250. Standard EMI involves interest charged by the customer's bank, whereas "No-Cost EMI" is subsidized by ShopSphere through a merchant subvention discount.

2. The Conversion Workflow and Bank Verification

When a customer selects an EMI option at checkout, the transaction is initially processed for the full cart amount on their credit card. This is a crucial point of customer confusion. CSRs must utilize the following customer communication protocols:

"Your card is initially charged for the full amount to secure the order. Within 3 to 5 business days, your bank will automatically convert this full charge into your chosen EMI plan, freeing up your remaining credit limit."

The bank verification and conversion process happens entirely on the issuer's back end. ShopSphere cannot expedite EMI conversions. If a customer reports that their transaction has not been converted to an EMI after 7 business days, they must be instructed to contact their credit card issuer directly.

3. Failed EMI Conversions

Occasionally, an EMI conversion fails due to the customer's card reaching its credit limit post-purchase, or due to their bank flagging the transaction. When an EMI conversion fails, the transaction defaults to a standard, single-payment credit card charge. ShopSphere is not responsible for failed EMI conversions or any resulting overdraft fees. The customer must resolve the issue with their financial institution or utilize the Order Cancellation Policy (KB-007) if the item has not yet shipped.

4. Order Cancellation and Refund Reversals

Handling refunds for EMI purchases requires careful explanation to the customer. If an EMI order is cancelled or returned, ShopSphere will issue a full refund of the principal purchase amount back to the original credit card.

However, refund reversal timelines and interest handling are strictly governed by the bank. Once ShopSphere refunds the principal, the bank will close the EMI loan. CSRs must warn the customer that any processing fees or interest charges levied by the bank during the first billing cycle are non-refundable by ShopSphere.

5. Partial Returns on EMI Orders

If a customer returns only a portion of an EMI order, ShopSphere issues a partial refund to the card. The bank will then either reduce the ongoing monthly installment amount or reduce the total tenure of the loan, depending on the specific bank's policies. CSRs must never attempt to calculate new EMI rates for the customer; always direct the customer to refer to their bank's updated amortization schedule once the partial refund clears the gateway.

KB-010: Fraud Detection and Security Review Workflow

Document Owner: Trust & Safety | **Applicability:** Fraud Analysts, Tier 2 Support | **Related Systems:** Automated Fraud Engine, OMS

1. Workflow Objective

ShopSphere is targeted by thousands of fraudulent transaction attempts daily. The Fraud Detection and Security Review Workflow is designed to mitigate chargebacks, protect legitimate customer accounts from takeover, and prevent the loss of high-value inventory. This document outlines how the Automated Fraud Engine scores transactions and dictates the escalation paths for manual review.

2. Automated System Flags and Scoring

Every order placed on ShopSphere is analyzed by the Fraud Engine in real time and assigned a Risk Score from 1 to 100.

- **Low Risk (1-49):** Order proceeds directly to the WMS for fulfillment.
- **Medium Risk (50-84):** Order is placed on a 4-hour "Soft Hold." The system performs secondary background checks (e.g., matching the IP address geolocation with the billing zip code).
- **High Risk (85-100):** Order is immediately blocked, and the transaction is voided.

Key triggers that inflate the Risk Score include severe billing/shipping address mismatches (e.g., billing in the US, shipping to a known freight forwarder in another country), high-velocity purchasing (placing more than 3 orders within a 10-minute window), and the use of anonymizing VPNs or proxies during checkout.

3. Fraud Review Escalation Paths

If an order falls into the Medium Risk category and fails the secondary background checks, the Fraud Engine will generate an alert in the manual review queue. Fraud Analysts have a strict 12-hour SLA to review these tickets. The analyst will review historical purchasing behavior, device fingerprinting, and bank verification statuses.

If the analyst determines the transaction is fraudulent, they will manually cancel the order and initiate account locking procedures. The customer's associated email, IP address, and device ID will be blacklisted in the system to prevent future attempts.

4. False Positives and Customer Communication Protocols

Automated systems occasionally flag legitimate customers, particularly those traveling abroad or buying expensive gifts (resulting in a billing/shipping mismatch). If a legitimate customer contacts support regarding a cancelled order or locked account, Tier 1 agents must follow the customer communication protocols precisely. They should not use the word "fraud." Instead, agents should state:

"Your order was intercepted by our automated security system to protect cardholders from unauthorized charges. To proceed, we need to verify your account."

5. Resolution and Account Restoration

When a false positive is identified, the CSR must route the customer through the standard Account Recovery and Verification Process (KB-008). Once the Trust & Safety team validates the customer's verification documents, they will manually whitelist the customer's profile in the

Fraud Engine. The customer will then be permitted to place a new order. Support agents are not authorized to manually override a High Risk transaction block; the customer must always re-enter the checkout flow once their profile is cleared.